Round 4, run 3, sub 1 – the Instruction of Amenemope (report)

▼ Contents

Done 1
Verification 2
Key findings 2
Decisions taken (minor, by me; all recorded in renderings §10) 4
Questions for the user 5
Problems and skipped items 5
Lessons for the guidelines, sources and tools 6
Cross-corpus splits left for the lead 7

Session `session_01HT9y418BXy7yfhyfoL3x2s` (child of `session_016VYybQrHJEd4FJNsbr7Be9`), 2026-10-23, 19:00–22:00 UTC.

Done

- **All 551 lines of pBM EA 10474 (KEY `AM`)**, 1.1–28.1: the prologue, the thirty houses, the epilogue and the colophon,
  none skipped. First draft, three review passes done; not yet reviewed by the user.
- Translators (Opus sub-agents, strictly one at a time): translator 1 did parts 1–2 (1.1–13.9), resumed after the merge;
  translator 2 (fresh, when the first one's context grew large) did parts 3–5 (13.10–28.1), resumed after each merge.
  Reviewers: pass (a) fidelity (one agent, both halves, resumed), pass (b) consistency, pass (c) Hebrew – each a fresh
  agent, one at a time.
- Files (`חכמה-ובריאה-במצרים/1-מוסר-אמנמופה/`): `annotated-AM.rtl.md` (4,283 lines), `translation--intro-AM.rtl.md`,
  `translation-AM.rtl.md` and `translation.rtl.md` (generated), `project.md` (the translators' five sections, the three
  review sections, the parallels table, a Status line). Print stub: `הדפסה/חכמה-ובריאה-במצרים/1-מוסר-אמנמופה.rtl.md`.

- Corpus files edited (allowed by the task): `renderings.md` (§7 fixed lines: 3.17 = 5.18 = 17.15; 4.2 = 7.10;
  5.19 = 17.16; 8.10 = 13.9; 9.6–8 = 16.12–14; 22.5–8 = 23.8–11; §10.1–10.7 the merged proposals and rulings; §1, §3a,
  §4.2, §4.4, §6 corrected), `egypt_tools.py` (gates and one converter fix, below), `parallels-index.md` (its table,
  regenerated by `build_parallels_index.py`; the key findings above it are the parent's).
- Commits on `main`: c70a7d5, e8580be, b3b22fa, cbe8cb4, ead36c3, e1eb93b (drafting); 1356cc8, 4af93aa, 5c9cac1, 1b25f11
  (review passes); eeed537 (print stub); this report.

Verification

- `python3 -I -B egypt_tools.py verify AM --strict`: 551/551 entries, **0 problems**, 0 repeated-line differences.
- `python3 -I -B egypt_tools.py selftest`: 31 lines, 0 failures.
- `python3 -I -B egypt_tools.py build AM`: 551 translation lines (equal to the `>` lines).
- `python3 -I tools/check_bible_quotes.py` on every file of the project (annotated, intro, both translations,
  project.md) and on `parallels-index.md`: **0 problems**.
- `python3 -I -B build_parallels_index.py`: 495 rows (project.md and parallels-index.md).

Key findings

For the Bible

- **Prov 22:17–24:22 against its source, saying by saying** (renderings §8, each pair checked on the transliteration):
  "give your ears" against `הַט אָזְנְךָ` (3.9, [divergence]); the oldest witness, oCairo SR 1840, reads "inside your belly"
  without the papyrus's "casket" – closer to `בְּבִטְנֶךָ` (Prov 22:18); 1.5–6 ↔ 22:21 (ꜥn ↔ `הֲשִׁיב לְהָשִׁיב`); 5–4.4 ↔
  22:22; 11.13–14 and 13.8–9 ↔ 22:24–25 (the same two prohibitions in the same order); 9.10–10.5 ↔ 23:4–5 (`עָשׂה יַעֲשֶׂה-לּוֹ כְנָפַיִם` has the Egyptian verb and noun; geese against the eagle; 9.19 = `וְאֵינֶנּוּ`); 8–23:6 ↔ 18–14.5 (snk `הִתְאַוָּה` =
  `תִּתְאָו`, the mouthful swallowed and vomited; but the victim is the poor man, not the `רַע עָיִן`); 3–23:1 ↔ 17–23.13
  ("the bowl that is before you" = `אֶת-אֲשֶׁר לְפָנֶיךָ`); 22:20 ↔ 27.7 (ketiv `שלשום` / qere `שָׁלְשִׁים`; `לְךָ` = n=k);
  27.16–17 ↔ 22:29.

- **The Torah's laws of the boundary, the measure and the weak:** 7.12–15 ↔ Deut 19:14, 27:17 and Prov 23:10 (the widow's boundary – the emendation 18.3–17.18 ;(גְּבוּל אַלְמָנָה ↔ Lev 19:35–36, Deut 25:13–16, Prov 16:11 (Egyptian too has two words for the balance: פֶּלֶס וּמֹאזְנֵי; Thoth made the weights as they are the Lord's 19.1–18.21 ;(מַעֲשֵׂהוּ ↔ Deut 25:14, Prov 20:10: the oipe "that takes two" against אֵיפָה – אֵיפָה וְאֵיפָה is the Egyptian loanword, and "its abomination" stands where the Bible says 18.23 ;תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה "the oipe is the Eye of Re" ↔ Zech 5:6 זֹאת עֵינָם; 24.9–17 ↔ Lev 19:14, Prov 17:5; 26.9–14 ↔ Deut 24:17–21, Prov 14:31, 19:17; 20.21–21.4 ↔ Ex 23:6–8, Deut 16:19, Lam 3:36; 16.5–7 (two thirds of a poor man's debt released) – a [divergence] from Deut 15's release.
- **Man as clay and straw, the god his builder** (24.13–20): Gen 2:7 / 2:22 וַיִּבֶן, Job 33:6, 1 Sam 2:6–7, Eccl 3:3; 24.4 "the heart of man is the god's nose" ↔ Gen 2:7 [divergence] (tTurin reads "the god's reward").
- **Loanwords in their own context:** תֵּבָה (11.4, the coffin), חָתַם, אֵיפָה (19.21, sin sealed ↔ Job 14:17), יְאֹר, (18.12) כֶּתֶם; and Semitic loans in Late Egyptian that take their Hebrew cognate: ʿšq עָשַׁק, mkmr.t מְכָמֹרֶת.
- Other: 19.11–13 ↔ Prov 27:1; 19.16–17 ↔ Prov 19:21, 16:9 (men "say", the god "does"); 19.18 "no one is free of sin" ↔ Prov 20:9, Eccl 7:20; 22.1–8 ↔ Prov 20:22 (the "strong superior" is a human patron one must *not* seek; the TLA's "Erlöser" behind the famous גֹּאֵל חָזָק pairing); 6.1–12 ↔ Ps 1:3, Jer 17:5–8.

For the ancient mind

- A land surveyor's conscience: he measures, registers, sets boundary stones, records the new Nile islands in the king's name, calibrates the Udjat measure; his sins are professional and so is the punishment (the cheat's son is not enrolled as a scribe, 17.14; one stolen furrow shortens your life; the Moon lassoes the man who "hunts" a field).
- The two men: the "hot" man whose tree is floated away and burned, the "silent" man whose tree flourishes in its own garden; burial is the measure of a life. Silence is power (the real crocodile does not roar; whoever "knows how to sleep" wins).

- Measures as divine eyes: the Udjat is Horus's healed eye, the oipe the Eye of Re; Thoth's baboon heart is the plummet
  of every market balance – the judgement of the dead in every transaction.
- Taboo becomes ethics (bw.t, a cult taboo, becomes the god's horror of lies); "no one is sinless", in a culture whose
  dead say "I have not sinned" forty-two times.
- Life as a Nile voyage: the tongue is the steering oar, the Lord of All the pilot; the ferry is a moral place (take the
  fare from the rich, let the poor cross free).
- Wealth behaves like a living thing: it does not sleep at your house, it sinks into the Duat or grows wings.
- The book speaks about itself (it pleasures, teaches, purifies); tTurin is a school tablet with "day 4", "day 8" in
  its margins – a pupil's daily stint; one copyist, Senu son of Pamiu ("the cat"), handed down the only complete text.

Decisions taken (minor, by me; all recorded in renderings §10)

- The refrain lines fixed by their first copies (§7, list above). **Correction of the pre-set §6/§8:** the "better"
  saying is not a four-line refrain – 9.5 and 16.11 differ in the Egyptian; only 9.6–8 = 16.12–14. The refrain of
  22.1–8 / 23.8–11 is four lines (22.5–8 = 23.8–11).
- All translators' proposals merged as §10.1–10.5 (about 120 lemmas: ʿn הֵשִׁיב, ḫꜣʿ עָזַב, shꜣ עִוֶּת, mj.t דֶּרֶךְ /
  wꜣ.t אֹרַח, the ship words one each, twr split by construction …); jr X = הִנֵּה X (§3a amended); ḫpr future
  כָּתֻם ;(4.4§) יְהִיָה added to the loanwords.
- **Cross-language collisions:** the Akkadian corpora's cognate reservations (עבר for *ebēru* …) bind Akkadian words;
  an Egyptian word takes the Hebrew of its meaning (§10.1.8) – **but not a loanword or rare technical word that is
  another corpus's cognate** (ʿḥwtj חוֹכֵר → אָרִיס, since אָרִיס < *errēšu*, §10.3.2). Common Semitic vocabulary
  (אַלְמָנָה, שֵׂכָר, מִדָּה, טִיט, תֶּבֶן, כָּבֵד) is shared: [cognate] in an Akkadian line, [equivalent] in an Egyptian one (§10.7.4). rwḏ.w סוֹכֵן kept (a sense word in its other corpora too).

- Gates widened (never the Hebrew bent): the `חם` gate no longer reads `לחם` "bread" as the hot man; the "better"
  formula no longer fires on the `r` of `ḥr-r-ỉ`; `יאור` licensed by the spelling `jwtwr`; `כתם` gated, licensed by the
  group writing `kꜣ~tj~mt`.
- The translators' philological open points (4.10 bgꜣ, 9.20, 10.9, 12.2, 14.11–12, 17.1, 18.5, 21.13, 27.1, 26.9) stay
  marked `?` / in italics with the alternatives in the apparatus – decided as the most defensible reading (guidelines
  §6.8, a crux), not questions for the user.

Questions for the user

None that blocks anything. Optional, if the user wants to weigh in:

1. twr (25.7, 25.9, 26.14, 27.12; 15.7) is split by construction into `נִטְהַר` / `הוֹקִיר` / `הִנָּזֵר מִן`, since no Hebrew verb holds "keep away from", "respect" and "be pure" at once. Keep the split?
2. 2.8 / 2.12 "true of voice" (= the late): of the father or of Amenemope himself – left open in the notes.

Problems and skipped items

- **No line skipped.** No quota stop (the status stayed `allowed` before every sub-agent).
- **Converter bug (fixed):** `egypt_tools.py` `_alt_gaps` turned AED's `<gap/>` into `/` only between two similar
  single words; between two multi-word analyses of one written stretch it printed `[...]`. The drafts therefore showed
  eight false lacunae and translated both analyses side by side (14.7, 16.8, 18.12, 22.2, 22.4, 23.16, 25.15, 27.8; the
  notes even called it a scribal doubling), plus 14.10. Found by the fidelity reviewer; fixed (every single mid-line gap
  in AM is a separator – the TLA's German marks no loss at any of them), each line retranslated once.
- **Gaps left `[...]`:** 27.17 (line end), 27.18 (three), 28.1 (line end): AED marks them lost; the TLA's German shows no
  loss there and Lange none at 27.17. Worth checking against the papyrus photographs (BM online) by a later session.
- Both translators' first saves broke a ★ rule once and fixed it themselves: translator 1 drafted the prologue
  vocalized (rewritten plene before going on); translator 2 wrote Lange's German from memory in house 10 (every quote
  wrong; replaced from the OCR).

- The earlier project.md sections (parts 2–5 scope lines) still count the eight false lacunae; the review section
  corrects them (left as the translators wrote them).

Lessons for the guidelines, sources and tools

- **Tools:** (1) An AED/TLA alternative-analysis separator can span several words: a converter must not print it as a
  lacuna; check every `[...]` inside a line against the TLA's German before the first line (tools.md, `egypt_tools.py`).
  (2) A **Hebrew → lemma-ids report** (from the פירוק bullets) catches collisions at once: the ship words collided across
  two translators and were found only at the fourth ship word; the consistency reviewer's scratch script did it for the
  whole text (2,338 words) – worth a `egypt_tools.py lexmap` command, and the same for every corpus tool.
  (3) `verify` should warn on heavily vocalized `>` lines (the ★ plene rule broke again on a first save).
  (4) Short gates (two-letter roots with up to three prefix letters) hit preposition + homograph (`בלחם`); formulas keyed
  on a one-letter word need boundaries that exclude compounds (`ḫr-r-ỉ`).
  (5) `check_bible_quotes.py` reads a bare "ch:v" after a backticked Hebrew word as Genesis.
- **Guidelines §5.2:** (1) The cognate rule across languages needs its scope stated: it protects loanwords and rare
  technical words (`אָרִיס`), not the common Semitic vocabulary that every corpus uses for its own word (§10.7.4 here).
  (2) A pre-set refrain list must be checked against the transliteration of *both* copies (Amenemope's "better" saying
  and its patron refrain were both mis-delimited in the pre-set renderings). (3) "Read the rank-3/5 translation only
  after drafting" also means: write its wording only with the source open. (4) A passage that will be fixed by its first
  copy should be drafted with both copies' contexts open. (5) The pattern worked: two translators, one per half, each
  resumed part by part; three fresh reviewers – the fidelity reviewer found the one systematic error.
- **Sources:** the BM papyrus photographs for the line ends of 27.17–28.1.

Cross-corpus splits left for the lead

- Shared common-Semitic words (Egyptian [equivalent], Akkadian [cognate]): אַלְמָנָה (ḫꜣr.t / *almattu*), שֵׂכָר (ḥnq.t / *šikaru*), מִדָּה (dbḥ / *maddattu*), טִיט (ꜥmꜥ.t / *ṭiṭṭu*), תֶּבֶן (dḥꜣ / *tibnu*), כָּבֵד (dns / *kabtu*) –
  kept by my ruling (§10.7.4); the lead may confirm it for every corpus.
- סוֹכֵן: AM rwḏ.w, Gudea *aĝrig*, the Advice *šatammu* – three source words, all by sense.
- חוֹכֵר (AM ꜥḥwtj) chosen to leave אָרִיס to *errēšu*.
- מִכְמֹרֶת (AM mkmr.t, a Semitic loan) = the cross-corpus מִכְמֹרֶת of *kamāru* – one word, as it should be.
- The other Egyptian projects (MK, MT, PT, HC) should follow AM's §10 words where they share lemmas (nṯr, ꜥnḫ, mꜣꜥ.t,
  jb / ḥꜣ.tj, the boat words, ḫpr, qd, ꜥmꜥ.t).